



NEW ZEALAND · MSCNZ

Registration for anaesthetic technicians

*The Medical Sciences Council route, and
what it asks of you.*

Ethicare Resourcing

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ethicareresourcing.com

What's inside

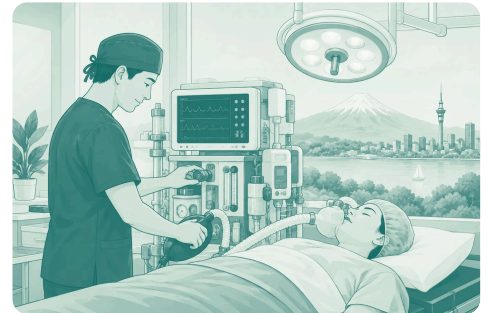
01 Registering as an anaesthetic technician

This guide is free, and so is everything in it. Every chapter here is also on the website, where it is kept up to date — so if you are reading this some months after downloading it, check the site for anything that looks time-sensitive. Fees, tax rates and immigration settings change without much notice.

We don't print these. A PDF costs nothing to send and nothing to ship, which felt like the right answer for a company that spends its days moving people around the world.

Registering as an anaesthetic technician

For internationally qualified anaesthetic technicians and UK operating department practitioners. Two routes in, one benchmark of two years' experience, and a scope that widened in April 2025 — which route you are on decides almost everything you submit. The checklist is built into the page, so nothing you tick goes out of date.



Regulator

Medical Sciences Council of New Zealand — Te Kaunihera Pūtaiao Hauora o Aotearoa — under the Health Practitioners Competence Assurance Act 2003

Source

The Council's published requirements at mscouncil.org.nz. Where this page and the Council differ, the Council is right.

Status

Checked 3 October 2026 against mscouncil.org.nz — the internationally qualified anaesthetic technician page, the scope of practice notice and the English Language Proficiency Policy v5. Fees are not printed here because the Council revises them.

Fees & timings

Fees deliberately not printed: non-refundable and revised. The Council states that where a full qualification assessment is required it may take up to 12 weeks to process an application.

AT A GLANCE

Two routes in

UK-trained and HCPC-registered is streamlined, with course information waived. Every other overseas qualification is assessed individually against the Council's criteria.

Two years' experience is the benchmark

The Council asks for two years' full-time equivalent post-qualification specialised experience. It publishes no hours figure, so evidence it in years and FTE, the way the Council states it.

The scope widened in April 2025

Aligning the role with the UK's ODP. Clearer pathways for operating department practitioners who meet the competencies.

The APC cannot be issued in advance

Registration can be in hand before you travel; the certificate that lets you work follows residence or evidence of your move.

What's inside

Read it once end to end, then come back to each section as you reach it. The checklist at the end remembers what you have ticked, on this device.

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SECTION 01

Understanding the Council

The Medical Sciences Council of New Zealand — Te Kaunihera Pūtaiao Hauora o Aotearoa — registers and oversees anaesthetic technicians, and medical laboratory science practitioners, under the Health Practitioners Competence Assurance Act 2003. Its purpose is to protect the public by making sure everyone practising is qualified, competent and fit to do so.

A protected scope of practice

You cannot lawfully work as an anaesthetic technician in New Zealand without registration with the Council and a current annual practising certificate. Registration confirms you have met the standard in the scope; the APC is what permits you to work, renewed every year.

Case-by-case assessment outside the UK route

Overseas qualifications other than recognised UK ones are assessed individually against a standard set of criteria approved by the Council. The quality and completeness of the evidence you provide directly shapes the outcome.

Confirm your pathway → Evidence, application and fee → Council assessment → Registration in the AT scope → APC once resident, then practise

The APC cannot be issued in advance.

You can only apply for your annual practising certificate once you are resident in New Zealand or can evidence your move. Registration can be in hand before you travel; the certificate that lets you work cannot. Plan the start date around that.

SECTION 02

Which pathway applies to you

Two broad routes, and placing yourself correctly early saves real time. The first is streamlined; the second weighs your qualification, registration and experience individually against the Council's criteria.

Route 1 — streamlined

UK-trained, HCPC-registered

You hold a United Kingdom qualification in anaesthetic technology and are registered and in good standing with the Health and Care Professions Council.

With two years' full-time equivalent post-qualification specialised anaesthetic technology experience you will generally be eligible, though the Council may require a period of supervised practice once you start.

Course information is still required. The Council's document list applies to all internationally qualified applicants and includes the academic transcript, the syllabus or curriculum in English, and the clinical logbook where applicable.

With less than two years' experience you can still apply and be assessed, which may include a Work-Based Assessment in practice.

Route 2 — individual assessment

All other overseas qualifications

You qualified outside the UK. Your qualification, registration and experience are weighed individually against the Council's standard criteria.

Training closer in scope to New Zealand's — Australia and Ireland, for example — tends to map more readily, but every application is considered on its own merits.

Course information is required: transcript, syllabus and clinical logbook where applicable (Section 04).

The completeness and clarity of that evidence is what decides the outcome and the timeline.

Check eligibility first.

Before assembling documents, complete the Council's Eligible check form. It gives you an early read on whether you can apply, so you know where you stand before investing time and money.

SECTION 03

The expanded scope, and what it means for ODPs

From 1 April 2025 a new Gazette notice broadened the activities and responsibilities anaesthetic technicians in New Zealand can undertake, aligning the role more closely with international roles such as the UK's Operating Department Practitioner.

The Council has said this reflects the increasing complexity of anaesthetic care and the need for a flexible, highly skilled workforce. Anaesthetic technicians may practise across operating departments, radiology, intensive care, maternity and emergency departments — anywhere anaesthesia is administered or airway emergencies are managed. Expanded scopes, for example post-anaesthetic care and peripherally inserted central catheters, are available on completion of an accredited training pathway and Council approval.

For ODPs

Clearer pathways into the New Zealand system

The expanded scope gives clearer registration pathways for Operating Department Practitioners who meet the relevant competencies. If you hold a recognised UK qualification and HCPC registration in good standing, you apply via the UK route in Section 02.

A profession in demand

On the skill-shortage list

Registered anaesthetic technicians sit on Immigration New Zealand's skill-shortage list, so the role is viewed favourably for visa purposes. Lists change — check the current one before you rely on it.

SECTION 04

Qualifications and experience

What the Council needs to see depends on your pathway. The qualification and the experience evidence are required on both; the course information is required only if you trained outside the UK.

Your qualification

Route

Both routes

Provide

A certified copy of your qualification — certified as a true copy by a solicitor, Notary Public, Justice of the Peace or an Officer of the Court.

Tip

Confirm who may certify and the wording before you pay; getting it wrong means doing it twice.

Course information

Route

Non-UK route only

Provide

Academic transcript in English — subjects, grades and the grading system used. Academic syllabus or curriculum — the contents of each subject and the hours for each year of study. Clinical logbook, if applicable — the procedures completed during the clinical component.

Mistake

Missing any of the three where the route requires them.

Employment and experience

Route

Both routes

Provide

A statement from your most recent or current employer with start and end dates, normal contracted hours per week, and job title. An up-to-date CV detailing your relevant work experience and the countries in which you worked.

Mistake

An employer statement that leaves the full-time-equivalent hours ambiguous.

Evidence the hours.

The two-year full-time equivalent requirement is central to the UK route. Make sure the employer statement puts the full-time-equivalent period beyond doubt — a vague letter is the most common cause of a follow-up query.

SECTION 05

Eligibility and documents

Alongside your qualification and experience, the Council needs a set of supporting documents. Each exists for a reason, and understanding why makes it easier to satisfy.

Present it like a professional portfolio: clean, high-resolution colour scans; pages straight and complete; consistent naming; certification done correctly the first time. A well-organised application is read more favourably, and assessed faster, than a disorganised one containing exactly the same facts.

Identity

Why

To confirm who you are and link your records.

Provide

A certified copy of your passport or another government-issued photo ID, and one passport-style photograph certified on the reverse as a true likeness by a Justice of the Peace or referee. Certified evidence of any

name change — marriage, birth or deed-poll certificate.

Current registration

Why

To confirm you are registered and in good standing where you practise.

Provide

Evidence of your current registration status and a Certificate of Good Standing — from the HCPC for UK applicants.

Timing

No more than six months old at submission. Requesting too early is a frequent, avoidable reason to start again.

Translations

Why

The Council assesses in English.

Provide

A certified translation to accompany any document not in English, supplied with the certified original.

SECTION 06

References and criminal history

Two requirements with precise rules that are easy to get slightly wrong — and both arrive at the Council directly from source, never via you, which makes them the slowest part of the file.

References

Two certificates of character

One Certificate of Standing and Experience — personal — completed by someone unrelated to you who has known you for a year or more.

One Certificate of Competence and Experience — professional — ideally from a registered anaesthetic technician. If you have not practised as an AT before, a recent lecturer or employer may be used.

Referees complete the Council's own template and return it directly to the Council. Tell them to expect an email.

Criminal history

Four rules

From each country you have lived or worked in for more than twelve months, from the age of sixteen.

Produced by the National Police Authority for that country — not a local or state office.

Sent directly to the Council from the issuing authority. Third-party pre-employment checks are not accepted.

No more than six months old on the day you submit.

A conviction is not an automatic bar.

The right approach is full, honest disclosure. Non-disclosure is treated far more seriously than most underlying matters.

— SECTION 07

English language requirements

Safe, precise communication with patients and colleagues in a high-stakes clinical environment.

Every applicant must meet the Council's English Language Policy, which sets out several routes — for example evidence that English was the sole language of instruction and assessment throughout your qualification, or a recognised test result. Where a test is required the Council accepts IELTS or the OET. IELTS asks for 7.0 in each of listening, reading and speaking and 6.5 in writing; the OET asks for a B pass. The Council does not accept the IELTS Online test or OET@Home. Confirm the current accepted tests and minimum scores against the Council's live policy before booking, because the policy is periodically updated.

Sitting the test too early.

Applications take time to assemble, so an early test risks expiring before you submit. Time it so the result remains valid when your application reaches the Council.

— SECTION 08

Cultural competence: the step you can start today

You must complete the Foundation Course in Healthcare and Te Tiriti o Waitangi, delivered by Mauri Ora Associates, and provide the certificate of completion with your application.

It builds your understanding of cultural competence and the obligations that flow from te Tiriti. Practice in New Zealand reflects a system-wide commitment to equitable health outcomes, and particularly to safeguarding the wellbeing of Māori. The Council's Cultural Competence Standards are part of the competence framework every registrant is expected to meet.

Required with the application

Foundation Course in Healthcare and Te Tiriti o Waitangi

Online, delivered by Mauri Ora Associates. Of everything in this guide it is the step you can most easily begin today, before gathering a single other document — and a genuine introduction to the healthcare culture you would be joining.

— SECTION 09

Applying, and what happens next

Once your evidence is assembled, the application itself is methodical.

1

Complete the Eligible check

Confirm you are eligible to apply before you commit time and money.

2

Confirm your pathway

UK and HCPC streamlined route, or individual assessment for other overseas qualifications.

3

Assemble your evidence

Qualification, experience, identity, registration, references, police checks, English, and the Mauri Ora certificate.

4

Submit your application and fee

Complete the application in the portal. The fee is paid on submission and is non-refundable.

5

Council assessment

Your qualification, experience and fitness are assessed. Supervised practice or a Work-Based Assessment may apply.

6

Registration, then your APC

Once registered in the AT scope, apply for your APC — required before you can practise, and only once you are resident or can evidence your move.

How long it takes — the Council's own figure

Up to 12 weeks where a qualification assessment is needed

The Council states that if a full qualification assessment is required it may take up to 12 weeks to process your application. Referee certificates and police checks must arrive directly from source, which is often the slowest-moving part — set those in motion early.

Fees

Always check the current figures

No amounts are printed here deliberately. Fees are non-refundable and the Council reviews them periodically. Confirm the current figures on the Council's official fees schedule before you budget or pay.

— WHERE PEOPLE GET STUCK

Almost every avoidable delay traces back to one of these

Wrong pathway assumption

Assuming a non-UK qualification follows the streamlined UK route. Confirm your pathway first.

Vague experience evidence

An employer statement that does not make the two years' full-time equivalent beyond doubt.

Third-party police check

A pre-employment background check instead of a national-authority check sent directly to the Council.

References sent via you

Referee certificates must reach the Council directly, on the Council's template.

Stale Certificate of Good Standing

Older than six months at submission. Time it carefully.

Course information gaps

Missing transcript, syllabus or logbook where the non-UK route requires them.

The fix for all of these

Do the Eligible check, confirm your pathway, set referees and police checks moving early, and have everything reviewed before you submit. Most of these are invisible to the person making them.

SECTION 11

The questions we are asked most

Should I do anything before applying?+

I am a UK-trained ODP. Can I work there?+

Do I need to provide my course syllabus?+

Will I need supervised practice?+

How long does registration take?+

When can I apply for my APC?+

Can Ethicare review my application?+

SECTION 12

The whole journey on one page

From first decision to first day at work. Each stage links to the section that explains it; the checklist tracks the same stages.

Before you start

Complete the Eligible check

The Council's own early read on whether you can apply — before a single document. [Section 02](#)

Before you start

Confirm your pathway

UK and HCPC streamlined, or individual assessment. It decides whether the course information is needed at all. [Section 02](#)

Preparing

Gather qualification and experience evidence

The certified qualification, the employer statement with unambiguous full-time-equivalent hours, and — outside the UK — transcript, syllabus and logbook. [Section 04](#)

Start today

Set referees and police checks moving

Both arrive at the Council directly from source, which makes them the slowest part. Keep the six-month limits in view. [Section 06](#)

Preparing

Settle English and complete the Te Tiriti course

Check the Council's English policy before booking a test. The Mauri Ora certificate goes in with the application. [Sections 07–08](#)

Applying

Submit with the fee

Everything in the portal, certified and in date at the same time. The Council states up to 12 weeks where a full qualification assessment is required. [Section 09](#)

Decision

Registration in the anaesthetic technician scope

Confirmed by the Council; supervised practice or a Work-Based Assessment may be set.

Then

APC once you arrive

It follows residence or evidence of your move — and only then can you practise.

Then

Employment, visa and the move

Where registration hands over to [planning your move](#).

THE CHECKLIST

Thirty-five items, in the order you will meet them

Tick as you go. Ticks are saved on this device only — nothing is sent to us — and the list is always the current version, which a downloaded copy never is.

0 of 35 ticked

01 Before you start

Confirm your pathway before you spend money or gather documents.

- ☐ **Confirm which pathway applies to you** UK-trained and HCPC-registered (streamlined), or any other overseas qualification (individual assessment).
- ☐ **Complete the Council's Eligible check form** An early read on whether you can apply, before you invest time.
- ☐ **UK route: confirm HCPC registration in good standing** Central to the streamlined pathway.
- ☐ **Note the two-year experience requirement** Two years' full-time equivalent post-qualification specialised anaesthetic technology experience, as the Council states it.
- ☐ **Note that fees are payable and non-refundable** Confirm the current figures on the Council's live fees schedule before paying.

02 Qualification and course information

What the Council assesses — the course information depends on your pathway.

- ☐ **Certified copy of your qualification** Certified as a true copy by a solicitor, Notary Public, JP or Officer of the Court.
- ☐ **Academic transcript in English (non-UK)** Subjects, grades and the grading system used. UK applicants exempt.
- ☐ **Academic syllabus or curriculum (non-UK)** Contents and hours for each year of study. UK applicants exempt.
- ☐ **Clinical logbook, if applicable (non-UK)** Procedures completed during the clinical component.

03 Experience and identity

Evidencing your experience and confirming who you are.

- ☐ **Employer statement with dates, hours and job title** Start and end dates and normal contracted hours per week — make the full-time-equivalent hours unambiguous.
- ☐ **Up-to-date CV** Relevant work experience and the countries you worked in.
- ☐ **Certified copy of your passport** Or another government-issued photo ID.
- ☐ **Certified passport-style photograph** Certified on the reverse as a true likeness by a JP or referee.
- ☐ **Evidence of any name change** Marriage, birth or deed-poll certificate, certified.

04 Registration and good standing

Confirming your current standing where you practise.

- ☐ **Evidence of current registration status** For example the HCPC for UK applicants.
- ☐ **Certificate of Good Standing under six months old** From your current licensing or registration authority. Time it to be in date at submission.
- ☐ **Certified translations of any non-English documents** Supplied with the certified original.

05 References

Two certificates of character, returned directly to the Council.

- ☐ **Certificate of Standing and Experience (personal)** From someone unrelated to you who has known you for a year or more.
- ☐ **Certificate of Competence and Experience (professional)** Ideally a registered anaesthetic technician; a recent lecturer or employer if you have not yet practised as an AT.
- ☐ **Referees use the Council's template** Tell them to expect an email from the Council.
- ☐ **References returned directly to the Council** Never via you — they go straight from the referee.

06Criminal history

Police records with precise rules — easy to get slightly wrong.

- ☐ **Police check from each country lived or worked in for 12 months or more** From the age of sixteen.
- ☐ **Produced by the National Police Authority** Not a local or state office.
- ☐ **Sent directly to the Council by the issuing authority** Third-party pre-employment checks are not accepted.
- ☐ **No more than six months old at submission** Time it so it is still valid when the Council receives it.

07English and cultural competence

Two requirements you can often get ahead of early.

- ☐ **Meet the Council's English Language Policy** Several routes — an English-medium qualification, or a test result.
- ☐ **Provide IELTS results if a test is required** Confirm the accepted tests and scores on the Council's live policy before booking; time it so the result is valid at submission.
- ☐ **Complete the Mauri Ora Te Tiriti foundation course** The Foundation Course in Healthcare and Te Tiriti o Waitangi.
- ☐ **Save and upload your completion certificate** Required as part of the application.

08Submit, register and after

Putting it together, and what follows.

- ☐ **Assemble a clean, organised application in the portal** Clear colour scans, certified where needed, consistent naming.
- ☐ **Pay the non-refundable fee on submission** Confirm the current figure first.
- ☐ **Submit to the Council** Up to 12 weeks where a full qualification assessment is required.
- ☐ **Respond promptly to any Council queries** Check your email and the portal home page for requests.
- ☐ **Registration confirmed** A period of supervised practice or a Work-Based Assessment may be set.
- ☐ **Apply for your APC once resident or moving** Required before you can practise. It cannot be issued in advance of residence or evidence of your move.

Print or save as PDF

WHAT NEXT?

Registration is one part of the decision

Check my pathway Registration and eligibility only — streamlined UK route or individual assessment, and whether supervised practice is likely. **How registration works in New Zealand** For every profession — the boards, the sequence, English and timelines. **Theatre and perioperative in New Zealand** The roles that share a theatre — and which regulator each one answers to. **Anaesthetic technician** What the work is like, indicative pay under the APEX agreement, where the theatres are. **Plan your move** Registration, visas, family and the order to do it in — personalised, saved in your browser.

HOW WE HELP

We can read it before the Council does

We review your evidence — particularly your experience documentation and pathway choice — against what the Council looks for, and flag likely issues while they are still easy to fix. We support and guide you through the process; the registration decision always rests with the Medical Sciences Council of New Zealand.

Talk to Ethicare

The Council's own site ↗